



Mr. Tapioca

The study app that ends at a boba counter.



Live on the App Store

THE PROBLEM

Students will focus for a reward.
The rewards are **fake**.

60M+

people use Forest, the biggest focus app

They lock their phones for hours to grow a tree that only exists on the screen. The focus-for-a-reward loop is proven at massive scale.

Six hours of studying earns you a cartoon tree.
You can't drink a tree.

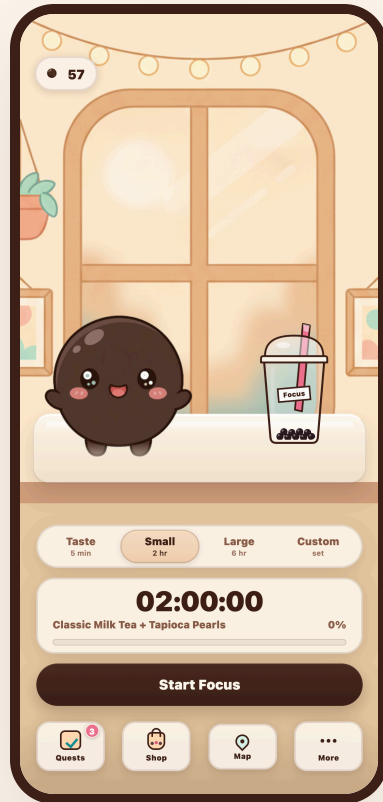
"Every focus app we tried was either a spreadsheet with a timer attached or a subscription in a trench coat."

from our App Store listing

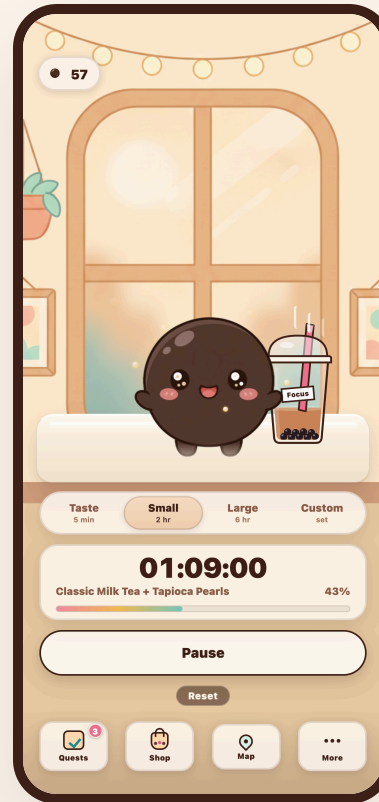
The focus loop works. Nobody has connected it to a reward **you can actually taste**.

THE PRODUCT · LIVE ON THE APP STORE SINCE JULY 2026

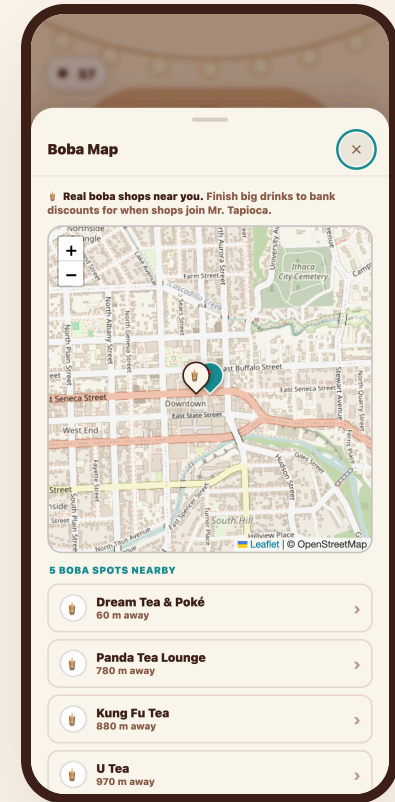
Block apps. Brew a drink.



Pick a drink, 5 minutes to 6 hours
Big drinks resume across study sessions



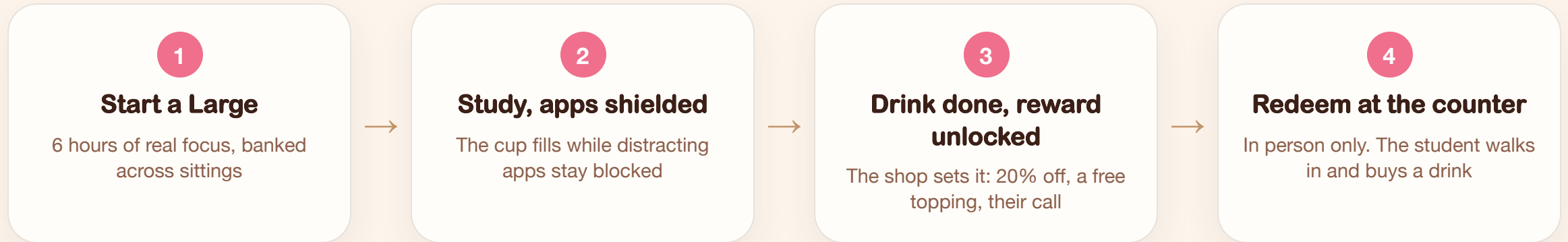
Distracting apps stay blocked while it brews
Apple Screen Time blocking, not a guilt trip



The Boba Map already shows real shops
Partner shops get the star. That's the business.

THE BUSINESS IDEA

Finish the drink. Then go drink it.



A partner shop never discounts a stranger. The only person who can redeem is a student **already standing at their counter.**

Shop picks the reward

In-person redemption only

Free for shops to join

TRACTION

Built in a summer. Selling in week one.

Live

on the App Store

Shipped July 2026 after passing full
App Review

Wk 1

first paying customers

\$1.99 cosmetic skins and
backgrounds, no ads, no
subscriptions



Apple Family Controls

The restricted Screen Time
entitlement real app blocking
requires

\$0

raised, 2 students

Web app, landing site, and 8 in-app
products, all live

Real app blocking requires a restricted Apple entitlement that takes weeks of review. **We have it, approved for distribution.**

THE MARKET

Boba is a **\$3B habit** parked next to campus.

~\$3B

global bubble tea sales

Growing roughly 8-10% a year (2025 industry estimates)

60M+

Forest users

Demand for gamified focus is already proven at scale

5

boba shops near downtown Ithaca

Straight from our own in-app map. The pilot market walks to class

College towns concentrate both sides of this market: students who study and shops that want them. **We start in ours.**

HOW IT MAKES MONEY

Free for students. Shops pay when it works.

Now · live

- \$1.99 one-time cosmetic skins and shop backgrounds
- No ads, no subscriptions, no tracking
- First purchases came in launch week

This fall · pilot

- Founding partner shops join free
- We hand-track every redemption
- Shops fund only the reward itself

After the pilot

- Small per-redemption fee, or a flat partner rate
- Priced under any advertising a shop could buy
- They pay only for a customer at the counter

For a shop, a redeemed drink is **performance marketing priced like a topping.**

We would spend eLab doing **exactly what eLab teaches.**

Shop discovery

- Interview every boba shop in Collegetown and downtown Ithaca
- Starting with the five already on our map: Dream Tea & Poké, Panda Tea Lounge, Kung Fu Tea, U Tea, and neighbors

Hypothesis to test: shops will fund a reward for verified student walk-ins.

Student discovery

- 100+ student interviews across campus
- In-app data: session length, completion, redemption intent

Hypothesis to test: a real drink stretches focus further than any cosmetic reward.

By December: **3 founding partner shops**, first tracked redemptions, and a keep-or-kill answer on the partner model.

TEAM

Two students who ship. Looking for a third.



Melchi Goldfarb

Cornell · founder

Designed and shipped Mr. Tapioca end to end:
Screen Time blocking, StoreKit, App Review.
Shipped a second app (RampUp, MCAT prep)
the same summer.



Dasha Nguyen

Tufts · art & brand

Character art, skins, and the cozy look that
makes people open the app twice.



Your name here

Cornell · growth & partnerships

We're recruiting our first Cornell teammate
through eLab to run growth and shop
partnerships with us.

THE ASK

The app is built. The business is the discovery.

What we want from eLab

- 1 Structure and reps for real customer discovery with shops and students
- 2 Mentors in food & beverage and consumer products
- 3 Our first Cornell teammate

By Demo Day, May 2027

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partner shops live in Ithaca with real rewards

1,000

finished drinks earned by students

1

partner playbook that copies to any college town